

Outlook Rules Setup Guide

Auto-Move Promotional & Sales Emails to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”

Step 1: Create the Destination Folder

Before creating rules, you need the target folder to exist.

In Outlook Desktop (Windows/Mac):

1. In the left sidebar, **right-click** on your **Inbox**
2. Select “**New Folder**”
3. Name it exactly: Trying to Sell Me Shit
4. Press **Enter**

In Outlook Web (outlook.office.com or outlook.com):

1. In the left sidebar, scroll down and click “**New folder**” (or right-click **Inbox**)
 2. Name it: Trying to Sell Me Shit
 3. Press **Enter**
-

Step 2: Open the Rules Manager

Outlook Desktop:

1. Click the **Home** tab in the ribbon
2. Click **Rules** → **Manage Rules & Alerts**

3. Click “**New Rule...**”

Outlook Web:

1. Click the **gear icon** (Settings) in the top-right corner
 2. Click “**View all Outlook settings**” at the bottom
 3. Go to **Mail → Rules**
 4. Click “**+ Add new rule**”
-

Step 3: Create Rule #1 — Catch Sales Keywords in Subject

This rule catches the most common promotional language used in subject lines.

Outlook Desktop:

1. In the Rules Wizard, select “**Apply rule on messages I receive**” → click **Next**
2. Check “**with specific words in the subject**”
3. Click the “**specific words**” link and add each of the following one at a time:
 - unsubscribe
 - limited time offer
 - limited time only
 - act now
 - don't miss out
 - exclusive offer
 - special offer
 - % off
 - save up to
 - free trial
 - free demo

- book a demo
- schedule a call
- get a quote
- pricing
- upgrade now
- buy now
- shop now
- order now
- flash sale
- clearance
- last chance
- today only
- expires soon
- you're invited
- congratulations, you
- you've been selected
- claim your
- unlock your
- your free

4. Click **Next**

5. Check “**move it to the specified folder**”

6. Click “**specified**” and select “**Trying to Sell Me Shit**” → click **OK**

7. Click **Next** → **Next** → give the rule a name like Sales Keywords - Subject

8. Click **Finish**

Outlook Web:

1. **Name:** Sales Keywords - Subject

2. **Condition:** “Subject includes” → add each keyword listed above

3. **Action:** “Move to” → select `Trying to Sell Me Shit`

4. Click **Save**

Step 4: Create Rule #2 — Catch Sales Keywords in Body

Same as Rule #1 but targets the email body, catching emails where the subject looks innocent but the body is a sales pitch.

Outlook Desktop:

1. New Rule → “**Apply rule on messages I receive**” → **Next**

2. Check “**with specific words in the message body**”

3. Add the same keyword list as Step 3 above, plus:

- `click here to unsubscribe`
- `you are receiving this email because`
- `to opt out`
- `manage your preferences`
- `view in browser`
- `this is a promotional email`

4. Action: **Move to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”**

5. Name it: `Sales Keywords - Body`

Outlook Web:

Same process as Step 3, but choose “**Body includes**” as the condition.

Step 5: Create Rule #3 — Catch Common Promotional Sender Domains

Many sales emails come from predictable no-reply or marketing domains. This rule catches them by sender address pattern.

Outlook Desktop:

1. New Rule → **“Apply rule on messages I receive”** → **Next**
2. Check **“with specific words in the sender’s address”**
3. Add the following:
 - `noreply@`
 - `no-reply@`
 - `donotreply@`
 - `marketing@`
 - `promotions@`
 - `newsletter@`
 - `offers@`
 - `deals@`
 - `sales@`
 - `info@` *(optional — only add if your boss doesn’t expect legitimate emails from info@ addresses)*
 - `notifications@`
 - `updates@`
4. Action: **Move to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”**
5. Name it: `Promo Sender Addresses`

Outlook Web:

Choose **“Sender’s address includes”** as the condition.

***Note:** Be careful with `sales@` and `info@` — if your boss has legitimate vendor contacts using those addresses, skip those two to avoid catching real emails.*

Step 6: Create Rule #4 — Catch Unread Emails Older Than 30 Days (Manual Sweep)

Outlook Rules don't natively support "never opened" as a condition, but you can do a **one-time manual sweep** for old unread emails.

In Outlook Desktop:

1. Click on the **Inbox**
2. In the **View** tab, click "**Filter Email**" → "**Unread**" — this filters to show only unread messages
3. Click the "**Received**" column header to sort by date (oldest first)
4. Select all emails older than your cutoff date (e.g., 30–90 days):
 - Click the first old email, then **Shift+Click** the last one to select a range
5. Right-click → "**Move**" → "**Trying to Sell Me Shit**"

In Outlook Web:

1. Click "**Filter**" at the top of the inbox → select "**Unread**"
 2. Sort by "**Oldest**"
 3. Select emails using the checkboxes → **Move**
-

Step 7: Apply Rules to Existing Inbox (Retroactive Cleanup)

After creating the rules, run them against your existing inbox to clean up what's already there.

Outlook Desktop:

1. Go to **Home** → **Rules** → **Manage Rules & Alerts**
2. Select each rule you just created
3. Click **“Run Rules Now...”**
4. Check **“Inbox”** as the folder to run against
5. Click **“Run Now”**

Outlook Web:

Outlook Web does not support running rules retroactively. You will need to use the manual sweep method in Step 6 for existing emails, or use the desktop app to run rules retroactively.

Pro Tips

Tip	Details
Check the folder regularly at first	For the first week, glance at “Trying to Sell Me Shit” to make sure no legitimate emails got caught. Adjust rules if needed.
Add specific senders as you go	When a new sales email slips through, right-click it → Rules → “Always move messages from [sender]” → select the folder.
Use “Stop processing more rules”	In each rule, check this option to prevent emails from matching multiple rules and being processed twice.
Focused Inbox	If Outlook’s Focused Inbox is enabled, also check the “Other” tab — many promos land there and can be bulk-moved.
Sweep tool (Outlook Web)	Right-click any sender → “Sweep” → “Move all messages from [sender]” — great for one-off bulk cleanup of a specific sender.

Summary of Rules Created

Rule Name	Condition	Action
Sales Keywords - Subject	Subject contains promo keywords	Move to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”
Sales Keywords - Body	Body contains promo keywords	Move to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”
Promo Sender Addresses	Sender address contains marketing patterns	Move to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”
Old Unread Sweep	Manual one-time filter (unread + old)	Move to “Trying to Sell Me Shit”